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Graduate Recruitment Team

Ruffer LLP

80 Victoria Street

London SW1E 5JL

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am applying for the Investment Graduate Programme in London. I am a final-year Economics student at the University of Strathclyde, graduating in summer 2027 with a predicted 2:1. Ruffer's absolute-return approach, which helped Ruffer Investment Company deliver a 4.6% NAV total return in the year to June 2026 while keeping its protective positions in place, reflects the risk-first thinking that runs through my own research.

My academic work centres on a question asset managers answer every day: what is a return worth once its risk is understood? I tested CAPM on 694 anomaly portfolios across 54 countries and found it fails jointly in 48 of 53, with momentum and value earning the most persistent alphas. My dissertation, supervised by Dr Luigi Gifuni, asks whether governments that hedge oil change how their currencies react to OPEC news, through Norway's krone conversions, Russia's 2017–22 budget rule and Mexico's put hedge, and whether any oil risk that remains is worth trading after costs, a question that matters to any portfolio with commodity or currency exposure.

Asset management appeals to me because it rewards a process that holds up over years rather than a single good call, and because the money belongs to people relying on that process. As co-founder of the Strathclyde Agricapital Society, which I grew to 126 members, I led weekly research sessions on transactions such as Olam Agri's USD 1.24bn stake sale to SALIC and published weekly research notes for members from outside finance. That work taught me that a sound view is only half the job; it also has to be explained clearly to the people who rely on it.

Ruffer stands out to me because it treats protecting capital as seriously as growing it: in the year to June 2026, Ruffer Investment Company's equity and gold positions more than paid for the cost of its protection, which spans credit and derivative strategies, the yen and selective duration. My dissertation is about protection too, asking whether governments' oil hedges, from Norway's krone conversions to Mexico's put options, change the risk their currencies carry, and I would like to learn how Ruffer's research team decides when protection is worth its cost.

I would welcome the opportunity to discuss my application. Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Will McGowan